

IKRAM RANA



THE 30-MINUTE INBOX

Clear your email in 30 minutes a day with 4 copy-paste AI prompts

No technical setup / free ChatGPT is enough / works today

ikramrana.com

THE SYSTEM I INSTALL FOR CONSULTING CLIENTS. FREE.

The work that feels productive usually isn't

Replying to emails feels productive. It isn't. It's the single biggest time drain in your business, and none of it is why you started.

I'm Ikram Rana. I build AI systems for law firms, dental clinics, contractors, realtors, and consultancies, and email is the first thing I fix in almost every engagement, because the numbers are brutal:

2-3 hrs PER DAY IN THE INBOX	500+ hrs PER YEAR	\$50,000 AT \$100/HR, ANNUALLY
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This guide is the exact system I install to take that to **30 minutes a day**. Not tips. A system: a triage method, four prompts, one voice trick, and a template habit. You'll run the whole thing today, and your replies will still sound like you.

THE DEAL

Give me 30 minutes today. If your inbox isn't dramatically faster by the end of it, unsubscribe and delete this. Fair?

The triage

Five minutes. Every email lands in one of three buckets.

1 Archive on sight

Newsletters, receipts, FYIs, cc-noise. **Don't read them. Archive.** This is 40 to 60 percent of most inboxes. Do a one-time bulk pass right now before anything else.

2 Reply Needed: star it

Anything that requires words from you. These go to the batch-drafting step next page.

3 Action Needed: flag it

Review, approve, schedule, decide. Rule: under 2 minutes, do it now. Longer, put it on the calendar. Doable by someone else, delegate it.

■ WHY TRIAGE FIRST

Drafting speed isn't your real problem. Context-switching is. Triage separates deciding from writing, so each starred email gets your judgment for 5 seconds instead of your attention for 5 minutes.

DO IT NOW

Open your inbox. Bulk-archive the noise layer. Star the replies, flag the actions. **Five minutes, go.**

Batch drafting: the 5-word trick

Fifteen minutes for the whole starred pile.

For each starred email: read it, jot the key points of your answer in **5 words or fewer**, and hand those 5 words plus the email to AI. You keep the judgment. AI does the typing. Edit for 30 seconds, send, next.

PROMPT 1 / THE GENERAL REPLY

Draft a reply to this email. Key points I want to make: **[your 5 words]**.
Tone: **[direct / friendly / formal]**. Under 150 words.
Sign off as **[name]**.
Write it the way I write: **[paste voice lines, below]**

Email: **[paste email]**

The voice trick (this is what makes it not sound like a robot)

Add three lines to the end of any prompt describing how you actually write. For example:

SAMPLE VOICE LINES, WRITE YOUR OWN

*"Short, direct sentences. Open with the point, no pleasantries. Close with a specific next step.
Never use: leverage, circle back, 'I hope this email finds you well.'"*

Ten seconds of setup, and the drafts stop sounding like a press release. This one trick is why most people fail with AI email and you won't.

The other three prompts

PROMPT 2 / THE FOLLOW-UP REPLY

Draft a follow-up email to [name] about [topic]. This is my second follow-up. We last spoke about [context]. Brief and friendly, end with a clear question or next step. Under 100 words.

PROMPT 3 / THE POLITE DECLINE

Draft a polite decline email for [describe the request]. Respectful, leave the door open for future opportunities. Under 80 words.

PROMPT 4 / THE MEETING CONFIRMATION

Draft a brief email confirming a meeting with [name] on [date] at [time]. Include the meeting link and any prep needed. Warm but professional. Under 100 words.

WORKED EXAMPLE / A PRICE PUSHBACK, HANDLED IN 60 SECONDS

Email: "The price is a bit higher than we budgeted. Can we discuss options?" **Your 5 words:** open to call, trim scope not price

"Hi Sarah, thanks for the straight answer on budget. Rather than cutting the price, the better move is usually trimming scope so you still get full quality on what matters most. Happy to walk through which pieces we could phase for later. Does Thursday afternoon work?"

Save the winners, never write them again

Five minutes of setup, then zero minutes forever.

The first time a prompt produces a reply you'd happily send again, save that reply as a template. Your five most common emails should never be written from scratch again.

1 Gmail

Settings, Advanced, enable **Templates**. Then in any draft: three-dot menu, Templates, Save draft as template.

2 Outlook

Select the reply text, Insert, **Quick Parts**, Save Selection to Quick Part Gallery.

YOUR 30-MINUTE INBOX, THE DAILY LOOP

- ☐ Triage: archive the noise, star replies, flag actions (5 min)
- ☐ Batch draft every starred email with the 5-word trick (15 min)
- ☐ Actions: under 2 minutes do now, else calendar or delegate (10 min)
- ☐ Any keeper reply gets saved as a template

■ THE MISTAKE TO AVOID

Perfectionist editing. If the draft is 85 percent right, fix the 15 percent and send. Done beats poetry; nobody's grading your emails.

THAT WAS ONE SYSTEM

Your inbox was leak #1. There are four more.

Get the full AI Business Ops Kit, \$27

All five systems: this inbox system plus client onboarding on autopilot, SOPs in minutes, follow-ups that never slip, and the weekly rhythm that ties it together. 5 guides, 16 prompts, worksheets, 2 videos, 2 Notion templates, and a 7-day sprint plan.

[STAN STORE LINK]

One practical AI system every week, free

No hype, no party tricks. Systems that survive contact with a real Monday morning, in your inbox weekly.

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Rather have it built for you?

Free 20-minute strategy call. Bring your messiest process; I'll map the fix live and tell you honestly whether it's worth automating.

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